

# **APPLE – INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE**

## **About the Company:**

Apple Inc. is one of the world's leading technology companies, headquartered in Cupertino, California. Founded in 1976, Apple has transformed the tech industry with revolutionary products like the iPhone, Mac, iPad, and Apple Watch, along with a powerful ecosystem of software and services. Known for its innovation, premium design, and global impact, Apple is consistently ranked among the most valuable and admired companies. For many aspiring engineers, Apple is a dream company—a place where cutting-edge technology meets creativity and excellence.

**Role:** Software Development Engineering Intern

## **Interview Process:**

The selection process comprised the following stages:

1. Online Test (Eliminatory)
2. Resume Shortlisting
3. Interview Round 1: Technical & Eliminatory (Eliminatory)
4. Interview Round 2: Techno-Managerial

## **Online Test:**

The first stage was an online test designed to filter candidates based on problem-solving ability and core technical knowledge. It included both coding challenges and concept-based questions. Only shortlisted candidates moved forward.

## **Coding problems:**

### **1. Restaurant Gain Calculation**

#### **Problem Statement:**

A restaurant has a fixed number of seats (*nbSeats*). Each guest is associated with an amount they are willing to pay (*payingGuests[id]*). The sequence of *guestMovements* represents guests entering and leaving the restaurant.

- The first appearance of an ID → *arrival*.
- The second appearance of the same ID → *departure*.
- The task is to calculate the *total gain of the restaurant for the day*, ensuring that at any given time the number of seated guests does not exceed *nbSeats*.

## 2. Tennis Game Scoring Simulation

### Problem Statement:

Implement the logic for scoring in a tennis game based on standard rules.

- Scores progress as:  $0 \rightarrow 15 \rightarrow 30 \rightarrow 40$ .
- When both players have  $\geq 3$  points and are tied  $\rightarrow$  *Deuce*.
- When both have  $\geq 3$  points but one leads by 1  $\rightarrow$  *Advantage (Player X)*.
- A player wins if they have at least 4 points and a lead of 2  $\rightarrow$  *Win (Player X)*.
- The task is to simulate the game and correctly output the score/state after each point.

### Technical Concept Questions:

The test also had objective type of questions from core CS domains such as:

- Programming fundamentals
- Operating Systems
- Databases
- Data Structures & Algorithms
- Time Complexity & Analysis
- Computer Networks

### Interview Round 1:

This round tested my problem-solving skills, how effectively I communicated and explained my approach, and how well I articulated my thoughts. Since the interviewer had knowledge about the models (that were used in my project) mentioned in my resume, the discussion started with questions related to my project work after I had introduced myself:

- **Project-related Questions:**

- Basics of Natural Language Processing (NLP).
- Tools and techniques like spaCy, transformers, and lemmatisation.
- Understanding of tokenization, embeddings, and NLP pipelines.

- **Coding Problem:**

- Merge Two Sorted Arrays: Given two sorted arrays, merge them into a single sorted array without using extra space. This tested both algorithmic thinking and in-place array manipulation skills.

This round was eliminatory, so solving the coding problem efficiently and explaining the project concepts clearly was crucial to move to the next round.

In the evening of the same day, I received an email and a call from Apple confirming that I had cleared the first round and would be appearing for the next round the following day.

### **Interview Round 2:**

This round was a mix of behavioral, managerial, and technical questions designed to evaluate not only technical depth but also communication, teamwork, and problem-solving approach in real-world scenarios.

- The interviewer started with her introduction and asked me to introduce myself, which set the tone for the discussion.
- The conversation then moved to my internship experience, including the projects I worked on, challenges I faced, and how I overcame them. More than half of the discussion focused on these experiences, testing collaboration, adaptability, and conflict-resolution skills.
- Some behavioral questions included:
  - What are your strengths?
  - How would you handle a situation where a teammate is struggling to keep up with the pace of a project?
  - Scenario-based technical questions, e.g., “What would you do if a search takes more time?”—testing knowledge of indexing, query optimization, and caching strategies.

This round assessed how well I could articulate my approach, reflect on past experiences, and apply learning from real projects, combining both behavioral insight and technical understanding.

After completing all the rounds, 10 students were selected for the role.

I hope my experience gives you some insights into the Apple recruitment process and helps you prepare better for such opportunities.

All the very best!

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